

key is to build a habit of curiosity and ask those clarifying questions we talked about earlier (see “[Inquiring inquisitively](#)”). Even for necessary things like gas. Maybe asking the right questions inspires you to ask a coworker or neighbor to alternate carpooling, saving both of you money and the opportunity to get to know each other better. I can’t tell you how many times I’ve heard a variation of the story “I tried a no-spend challenge, but I always end up buying [insert necessity], so I never completed it.” Don’t let perfect be the enemy of the good—come at this process from a place of curiosity.

“I’m waiting for a month where I don’t have something to do.”

That month will never come. And while we’re on the subject, you also don’t have to wait for the first day of the month. During the last no-spend challenge I did, we planned a trip to LEGOLAND. We have annual passes, so we go every other month to feel like we’re getting our money’s worth, and one month happened to fall on my no-spend challenge. Instead of postponing the start of the challenge, I used it as an opportunity to get creative and see how little we could spend. I packed sandwiches, snacks, drinks, the whole shebang. I made coffee at home and brought it with me in the car. And you know what? The only money we spent that day was on a hot dinner outside the park before we made the hour drive home. While I didn’t have a total no-spend day, I wouldn’t have been as motivated to not spend if I wasn’t on the no-spend challenge. If you see a thirty-day window that you think is mostly good, schedule your challenge! And when those one or two days come up when you know you’re going to spend, whether it’s at a wedding, other event, vacation, whatever, challenge yourself to get creative with how or how much you spend.

“What if something I need goes on sale?!”

January is a popular month for our listeners to do no-spend challenges. When we surveyed them fourteen days in about what the hardest part was so far, we were shocked to hear how many people said “missing out on all